

Robin Rowland

PhD Candidate
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Key skills

Data management • Statistical analysis (R) • Project coordination • Stakeholder engagement • Scientific communication

Wildlife ecologist with demonstrated experience in data management, technical analysis and reporting, and stakeholder engagement across academic, government, and community partners. Skilled in maintaining large ecological datasets and communicating complex scientific information to diverse audiences. Proven project coordination and committee experience, and strong statistical analysis skills in R.

Education

- 2023 - present **Doctor of Philosophy**, University of the Sunshine Coast
Thesis: Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats
Anticipated completion: January 2026
- 2012 - 2016 **Bachelor of Arts (Honours Program), Animal Behaviour**, Eckerd College, USA

Relevant experience

- 2023 - present **PhD Researcher**, University of the Sunshine Coast, QLD
- Lead a research project examining the effects of urbanisation and roost environments on insectivorous bat health and physiology
 - Developed an open-access continental-scale database of Australian bat roost associations and a complementary functional-trait database
 - Work with private landholders, non-profit organisations, and state and local government, and communicate findings to stakeholders
 - Mentor and assist with supervision and experimental design of six student research projects (three undergraduate, three honours)
- 2024 - present **Student Scholar**, GBatNet Global Union of Bat Diversity Networks
- Participate in international working groups and meetings involving bat researchers, conservation practitioners, and other specialists
 - Collaborate on a global review of Data Deficient bat species, including the creation, cleaning, and management of a large citation database
 - Contribute to the development of globally relevant scientific communication guidelines as part of the Global Bat Communication Guidelines Working Group

2023 - present	Tutor, University of the Sunshine Coast, QLD <i>ANM100 - Animal Ecology Field Course</i> (×4) • Deliver course content on bat acoustics and provide support and instruction for first-year university students during a field course on North Stradbroke Island (Minjerribah) • Demonstrate ecological field techniques, including transects, acoustic monitoring, and animal identification, across diverse terrains and adapt delivery to varied student abilities <i>ANM103 - Animal Form and Function</i> (×4) <i>ENS222 - Terrestrial Vertebrate Diversity & Ecology</i> (×3) • Instruct university students in laboratory techniques and scientific writing, moderate discussions, and mark assignments within short turnaround periods • Lead student groups on annual vertebrate identification field trips
2017 - 2023	Outreach Coordinator, Tamborine Mountain Glow Worm Caves, QLD • Liaised with tour and school groups, production companies, and news agencies to deliver tailored wildlife conservation information in a fast-paced environment • Represented the company at academic conferences and communicated with the public and scientific community through emails, reports, and reviews
Aug 2019 - Dec 2022	Literature Database Manager & Website Editor, Wildlife Tourism Australia • Sorted and standardised an existing literature database to improve accessibility, integrated an embedded Zotero library, and provided ongoing updates for new publications • Maintained and updated website content to reflect information and updates from individual member sites
2016	Research Intern, Busch Gardens Animal Research Center, USA • Collected and analysed behavioural, physiological, and parasite data on a range of mammalian and avian species • Coordinated with other researchers to design novel experiments and deliver results from multiple parallel projects to internal and external stakeholders
2015	Research Intern, Savannah State University Dolphin Science Lab, USA • Collected behavioural and environmental data on bottlenose dolphin individuals during weekly field surveys and assisted with database updates and maintenance • After the internship concluded, worked remotely with the laboratory to complete a study examining injury rates in local dolphin populations

Service roles

2026	Bats in Buildings Working Group Member
2026	UniSC HDR Retreat Organising Committee
2023 - present	Treasurer , UniSC Ecological Society
2020 - 2024	Committee Member , Wildlife Preservation Society of QLD - Scenic Rim
2019 - present	Wildlife Rescuer & Workshop Co-Lead , Bats Queensland

Grants and awards

2025	Data Deficient Bat Working Group Funding (21,851), GBatNet Global Union of Bat Diversity Networks Co-investigator
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2024	Establishing vital roost characteristics to facilitate urban insectivorous bat conservation (49,586), WIRES National Research Grant Co-investigator
2023 - 2026	Insectivorous Bats in South East Queensland (20,720), Holsworth Wildlife Research Endowment Lead Author
2023	Radio Transmitters for Insectivorous Bats (2,720), Holohil Transmitter Grant Program Lead Author
2023	Bat Roost Identification (1,197), Wildlife Acoustics Scientific Product Grant Lead Author
2021	Wildlife Corridors in the Scenic Rim (49,000), Landcare Led Bushfire Recovery Grants Lead Author
2020	Educational Workshops and Events for Bat Carers (1,950), Logan EnviroGrants Lead Author
2020	ICUs for Bat Carers Capacity Building (9,900), Logan EnviroGrants Lead Author

Invited presentations

Apr-2026	GBatNet 'My Field for Dummies' Online Series Urban Bat Ecology
Oct-2025	University of the Third Age Sunshine Coast Bats in Our Backyards - Get to Know Our Nocturnal Neighbours
Jul-2025	UniSC Ecological Society Introduction to Zotero and Scientific Citations
Sep-2024	UniSC Ecological Society Ecological Careers Workshop
Aug-2024	UniSC Ecological Society Introduction to Scientific Writing

Presentations and posters

Aug-2026	Physiological Tools for Monitoring Urban Impacts at The Roost Level in Insectivorous Bats Talk - Joint Conference of the Australian Mammal Society and Australasian Bat Society, Australia
Dec-2025	Stressed Out Bats: Developing Tools to Monitor Physiological Stress in Three Insectivorous Species Talk - Australian and New Zealand Society for Comparative Physiology and Biochemistry Meeting, Australia
Nov-2025	Bats Are in The Building: Understanding Anthropogenic Roost Selection Through Habitat Models Talk - Ecological Society of Australia Conference, Australia

Aug-2025	No One Size Fits All: Exploring Anthropogenic Roost Selection Across an Urban Gradient in South East Queensland Talk - 20th International Bat Research Conference, Australia
Aug-2025	The System Works: Post-Release Survival of Rehabilitated Insectivorous Bats in Australia Talk - 20th International Bat Research Conference, Australia
Jul-2025	Home Is Where the Bats Are: Bats in Man-Made Structures in South East Queensland Talk - Animal Ecology Seminar Series, The University of the Sunshine Coast, Australia
Oct-2024	Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, A Public Dataset Poster - North American Bat Society Conference, Mexico
Jul-2024	Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, A Public Dataset Poster - School of Science, Technology and Engineering Research Conference, Best Student Poster
Apr-2024	From Rugs to Rocky Overhangs: Diverse Microclimates of Natural and Anthropogenic Bat Roosts in South East Queensland Talk - 21st Australasian Bat Society Conference, Australia
Apr-2024	Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, A Public Dataset Poster - Australasian Bat Society Conference, Australia, Runner Up Student Poster
Nov-2023	Working with Bat Landlords to Study the Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats in South East Queensland Talk - Australian Citizen Science Conference, Australia
Feb-2020	The Success of a Wildlife Corridor on Tamborine Mountain and the Value of Landcare Talk - Wildlife Preservation Society Scenic Rim Corridors Workshop, Australia
Dec-2019	The Scenic Rim and Its Potential Role as an Ethical Wildlife Tourism Destination Talk - The Scenic Rim as an Environmentally-Sustainable International Wildlife Destination Workshop, Australia
Oct-2018	Can Glow-worm Ecotourism Lead to Increased Conservation Knowledge and Positive Intentions Towards Glow-worms in the Wild? Talk - 5th National Wildlife Tourism Australia Conference, Australia
Apr-2016	Do Common Bottlenose Dolphins That Interact with Humans Experience Greater Rates of Anthropogenic Injuries? Talk - Southeast and Mid-Atlantic Marine Mammal Symposium, USA, Best Undergraduate Oral Presentation
Apr-2015	Can Mongoose Lemurs Recognize Individual Humans? Poster - 23rd International Conference on Comparative Cognition, USA

Science communication

Jan-2026	ABC Sunshine Coast Radio, Wide Bay, Southern Queensland , Commenting on Noosa Flying Fox Mass Entanglement Event
Jan-2026	ABC Sunshine Coast Radio , Commenting on Annual Influx of Little Red Flying Foxes in the Region
Aug-2024	ABC Sunshine Coast, ABC Australia , Commenting on Arson Incident on Mooloolah Valley Bat Colony

Jul-2024	TalkECO Podcast , Microbats , Chicken Nuggets , Stress and Wildlife Rescue!
Feb-2024	Sunshine Coast News , Study to Help Save Mini Bats That Fly Under the Radar
Feb-2024	ABC Sunshine Coast Breakfast Radio , Research to Save Tiny Bats from Housing Crisis
Jul-2023	Cosmos Magazine , Little Forest Bats: Earth's Tiniest Heroes (Australian Mammal of the Year Profile)

Outreach

Mar-2026	Bat Workshop and Echolocation Walk , Moreton Bay Council
Mar-2026	Invited Speaker and Exhibit Consultant, Queensland Museum Bat Night Market Exhibit , World Science Festival Brisbane
Nov-2025	Bats in Buildings on the Sunshine Coast, Maleny Bat Night , Sunshine Coast Council
Oct-2025	Bats of the Sunshine Coast Workshop and Bat Walk , Mooloolah River Landcare
Oct-2025	Bats in Your Backyard: Crash Course to the Bats of SEQ ('What's Brewing Behind the Dunes' Series) , Cooloom CoastCare
Nov-2024	Bat Workshop and Spotlighting Walk , UniSC Ecological Society
Oct-2024	Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats, Maleny Bat Night , Sunshine Coast Council
Oct-2024	Bat Workshop and Echolocation Walk , Moreton Bay Council
Sep-2024	Bat Call Walk and Workshop Leader , Springfield Lakes Nature Centre
May-2024	Bats and Forests: We Need Bats More Than You Think! , Maleny Wood Expo, Maleny, QLD
Apr-2024	Bat Call Walk Leader, Microbat Discovery Walk Series , Brisbane Catchments Network
Oct-2023	Sunshine Coast Citizen Science Bat Walk , Sunshine Coast BioBlitz

Skills and certifications

- Statistical analysis in R - linear modelling, mixed modelling, and spatial modelling with temporal and spatial autocorrelation (UQ R Course)
- Operate and Maintain 4WD Vehicle (RIIVEH305F)
- Provide Advanced Resuscitation and Oxygen Therapy First Aid (HLTAID015)
- Provide Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation - CPR (HLTAID009)

Referees

Dr Clare Stawski (Primary Supervisor) - Senior Lecturer, University of the Sunshine Coast
cstawski@usc.edu.au |

Dr Alexis Levensgood (Co-Supervisor and Field Course Leader) - Research Fellow, University of the Sunshine Coast
alevengo@usc.edu.au |